

BEYOND THE MAP'S EDGE — MASTER REFERENCE FILE

Compiled September 5, 2026

Hunt by Justin M. Posey. Launched March 27, 2025 alongside the book *Beyond the Map's Edge* and the Netflix docuseries *Gold & Greed: The Hunt for Fenn's Treasure*. Treasure hidden 2023. Unfound as of this compilation.

Sourcing note. Section 1 is transcribed from the official rules page at treasure.quest. Sections 2 through 9 are compiled largely from Jenny Kile's Mysterious Writings aggregation of Posey's Q&A appearances, which is reliable secondhand rather than primary transcript. Primary sessions referenced: Dillon, MT book signing Q&A (June 21, 2025); X Marks the Pod interview (Sept 4, 2025); Sandal interview (Sept 27, 2025); Seekers Summit, Tucson (March 28, 2026); monthly Featured Questions segment on Mysterious Writings (began July 2026). Sections 10 and 11 are the working solve, not established fact.

1. OFFICIAL RULES (treasure.quest)

Definitions

- **Treasure** — the final prize you're looking for
- **Clues** — all hints that help you find the treasure
- **Hunt Items** — both the treasure and all clues

Note: the restrictions below apply to Hunt Items, meaning the checkpoint and any placed clue are bound by the same list as the treasure itself.

Where Hunt Items are NOT

- Underwater
- On private property
- In caves, mines, tunnels
- At places that need rappelling

- Associated with any man-made buildings
- Near graves or grave markers
- In dangerous places

What all Hunt Items ARE

- More than 1 mile away from anywhere Posey, his family, or friends live, work, or own property, including property their businesses own
- On publicly accessible land anyone can visit
- Safe to get to

You DON'T need

- Climbing gear or ropes
- Permission to enter private land, because it isn't on private land
- Swimming skills
- Ladders or climbing skills
- A high-clearance vehicle

Also

- Please use common sense
- Safety guidelines published at treasure.quest/safety
- Posey: nothing dangerous is required to find the treasure

2. HUNT MECHANICS

- All essential clues are in the poem, free on treasure.quest
- Poem is 5 stanzas, 4 lines each
- At least 10 clues in the poem
- Clues are in consecutive order, top to bottom (confirmed on his website announcements)
- However, asked at Seekers Summit whether the poem needs to be read or rearranged in

any way other than as presented: **"I'm not going to rule that out."**

- No red herrings
 - No hidden codes in the website's source code
 - A "fair amount" can be solved from home
 - Boots on the ground required for retrieval
 - If the poem is solved in its entirety, an exact location is given
 - One cipher exists, plus one hint he describes as somewhat technical; neither is critical to the solution
 - Asked whether the cipher sits in one section of the book or spans several: **"Who says the cipher is in the book?"**
 - Asked whether numbers are indirectly encoded (wordplay, homophones, hidden in words): confirmed **yes**, there are numbers indirectly associated with the poem. Declined to address homophones specifically. Confirmed there **is a distance element** in following the clues.
 - The map is useful. Treasure is hidden within the map, not beyond its edge.
 - All clues expected to stand the test of time; he will announce if something drastic changes
 - Punted on whether he has the ability to view searchers when they are near the treasure
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3. SEQUENCE, DISTANCE, RETRIEVAL

- **First actionable clue:** "As hope surges, clear and bright" (stanza 2, line 1)
- **Last actionable clue:** stanza four or five, depending on interpretation
- **Boots on the ground becomes absolutely required at stanza four.** Implication: stanzas 1 through 3 are intended to be solvable from home.
- Walking distance from "waters' silent flight" through "round the bend, past the Hole"
- No need to hike more than a mile **to figure out where the treasure is at** — his phrasing, which searchers note is not the same as "to find it"
- "How far from the first clue to the last in miles" — he called this impossible to answer given how the clues are structured

- On retrieval: "By the time you're going to get the treasure you're not searching, you're retrieving"
 - "Once you figure out exactly where the treasure is at you will have sufficient time to plan how you wish to retrieve it"
 - Something will need to be manipulated in order to see the treasure; depending on conditions a flashlight could be helpful
 - Punted separately on whether you need to move any rocks
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4. THE CHECKPOINT

- Built-in checkpoint gives the reassuring feeling that you aren't lost and wasting vacation days
- Will give you **zero doubt** you are trending in the right direction
- You are at least halfway through the poem clues when you reach it
- It is part of the poem, since it is a stage of the journey
- Excellent chance you find the treasure if you're first to the checkpoint
- **"You'd be hard pressed to get all the way without seeing the checkpoint"**
- The thing you find along the way is **both** something he placed and something already there
- Asked if the checkpoint is finitely connected to a topographic feature: "there is some implication there"
- Asked if it's a physical object that can be moved: "not something you need to worry about"
- Punted on whether it remains findable by others once located
- Not visible in *Gold & Greed*
- **Zero** searchers have sent him a photo of the correct checkpoint
- Possible to be at the checkpoint and not recognize it, depending how close you are
- June 21, 2025: no one had reached it to his knowledge
- August 1, 2025 (posted on X): several searchers have solved at least the first two clues, and some have been **within 200 feet of the checkpoint**

- He will announce when the checkpoint is reached, if he becomes aware
 - The audiobook adds a chapter containing the word “checkpoint,” widely read as confirming it cannot be identified from home
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5. STANZA 3 — THE BRIDE, THE REALM, THE GATES

On the bride

- Not a person who is alive right now
- Clarified intent: he does not want anyone thinking the bride is a living person you can interact with, because he wants to prevent searchers hassling real people
- **The bride is something that is visible**
- **Someone has correctly identified the bride** (confirmed at Seekers Summit)
- Her face does belong to the bride: yes
- **“Return her face” does imply a physical rotation — “the technically correct answer is yes”**
- “Return her face to find the place” — the distance from her face to the place is “probably not as far as many people might think”
- You do **not** need to be at the bride to identify her foot of three
- Distance from the bride to the treasure: “a matter of perspective”
- It would be “a little strange” to discover the bride without understanding the ancient gates

On his realm and ursa

- Asked whether “he” is living or was ever living: **“That depends on your perspective”**
- Only need to worry about Ursa East; there is no separate west Ursa to consider
- The lowercase “ursa” was deliberate. On an anagram reading such as “use a star”: “the poem was written deliberately, so the choice of not capitalizing was intentional, but that’s all the clarity I’m willing to provide”

Solve status

- **Part of stanza 3 has been solved** by searchers, at least in part

- “The place” and “the sacred space” are not necessarily the same location
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6. STANZA 2 AND STANZA 4 STATEMENTS

- **The Hole carries no man-made implication** (direct “no” at Seekers Summit)
 - Punted on whether the Hole corresponds to a place with “hole” in its name, e.g. Jackson Hole or Big Hole River, calling it “an on the nose question”
 - Punted on whether “double arcs on granite bold” is the clue with the man-made implication — widely read as a soft yes, given the Hole was a clean no
 - At Dillon, would not answer whether the double arcs exist naturally or were created, calling it a strange question to answer since he knows what he knows
 - Whether “cast your pole” refers to a fishing pole: **has not specified**
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7. EXPLICIT NON-ANSWERS

- Are national parks ruled out? Won’t say yes or no
 - Do you need to move any rocks? Punt
 - Does the treasure location predate any of the sites you searched for Fenn? Has not specified
 - Are there references to specific Native American legends in the poem? Has not specified
 - Are there clues related to golf? Has not specified
 - Can you view searchers near the treasure? Punt
 - Asked point blank where the treasure is: on earth, in the American West, not a place you have to go many miles to find. Added that searchers are going too deep into wilderness, rappelling into caves and searching cliffsides. **“If you need rope then it’s not the right location.”**
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8. GEOGRAPHY AND ELIMINATIONS

- Hidden somewhere in the American West, within the printed map
- **Colorado eliminated** (Seekers Summit, intentional)

- **Oregon eliminated** (Seekers Summit, intentional)
 - Confirmed he had at some point searched for the Fenn chest within 75 miles of where he hid his own treasure. He then walked this back, saying he didn't want people thinking he'd eliminated a bunch of states, and noting he had questioned whether Fenn's site was even in the official Rocky Mountains as opposed to any mountains with rocks. Searchers infer from Fenn's "north of Santa Fe" framing that everything roughly 75 miles south of Santa Fe is out. **This inference is the community's, not Posey's statement.**
 - Access to the location is free and available 24/7
 - Not near any trail. Deliberate, so it wouldn't be stumbled upon.
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9. THE BOOK, AUDIOBOOK, DOCUMENTARY, SONGS

Book

- 220 pages, memoir with hints scattered throughout
- Clues and hints are the same thing in his view
- Book is a better clue resource than the documentary
- There are many clues in the book, but not every story contains one
- Intentional differences between hardcover and digital; he said the differences hold insights
- Hardcover contains two more images than digital, on pages 4 and 117
- **Page 90 does not exist**; pages run 89 to 91, inside chapter 9
- **Page 156 is missing its page number** where comparable pages have theirs
- Cover: the M in "Map's" is cut short. Searchers have proposed the cover outline matches a watershed or terrain outline.

Audiobook differences

- *The Concrete Kiss*: the "Big Hill" speed-bump line says Idaho in hardcover (p. 43), Utah in the audiobook. The hill illustration is on page 42. Idaho and Utah share the 42nd parallel.
- Acknowledgements: added sentence about the difference between reality and fantasy not being a wall but a map waiting to be drawn

- *Trailside Troubles*: "The" added to the chapter title (p. 113 hardcover)
- *The Treasure Trail*: on p. 185 there's a search list; the narrator adds that two entries remained uncrossed
- An added chapter uses the word "checkpoint"

Netflix

- He had no creative control, and did not know scene order, framing, or focus
- He hid hints during filming that not even the producers knew about
- At least 5 singular clues, plus compound clues requiring several scenes
- **Two hints he considers obvious remain unfound**, in a scene he does not appear in but had some control over
- Eliminated the clock times 4:02 and 5:26 as meaningful
- Searchers note a "Bureau of Land Management" placard visible in a packing scene, proposed as one of the obvious hints

Songs

- There are clues in the hunt's songs
- One song contains what he called an extremely definitive clue

10. THE TREASURE AND CLAIMING

- Roughly 60 pounds including container
- Most items are gold
- Contents: gold bars, precious gems, rare coins, a meteorite, historical artifacts dating to 561 BC, items from the Forrest Fenn chest, and a Bitcoin wallet funded by a portion of book sales
- Valued at over a million dollars; he has indicated he is legally constrained from stating a total
- Container will be immediately recognizable as his, not a Fenn replica
- A separate holder called the Steward holds additional treasure items
- Finders keepers

- Finder may remain anonymous
- Finder must come forward within 30 days to claim the Bitcoin portion
- The complete solution will be revealed at the conclusion of the hunt

Posey background: searched for the Fenn treasure for years, featured in *Gold & Greed* and in New York Magazine's "The Great 21st-Century Treasure Hunt." Bought the Fenn chest from finder Jack Stuef, sold most contents at auction December 2022, kept the chest, the dragon bracelet, a few coins, dust and flakes. Software engineer, art and antique dealer, raised in Arizona, based in Texas. Dedicated the hunt to four late loved ones: his father, grandfather, brother Brandon, and his dog Tucker.

11. WORKING SOLVE — MOAB / LA SAL MOUNTAINS

Status: unverified working theory. Nothing in this section is confirmed by Posey.

Core claim: the poem runs from a spring north of Moab, Utah, west along the Colorado River on Highway 279 (Potash Road) to Jeep Arch, then orients east toward the La Sal Mountains.

Line-by-line

Stanza 1 — reading method, not geography

- L1 (lives in time) — Unsolved. Read "time" literally: clock, date, hours.
- L2 (measured rhyme) — Unsolved. Counting is the method: words per line, syllables, positions.
- L3 (shadowed sight) — Unsolved. Ends on an em dash, one of only two in the poem.
- L4 (read these words just right) — Unsolved. Confirms the stanza is instruction, not movement. Likely tied to the cipher.

Stanza 2 — the approach

- L1 (hope surges) — **Matrimony Spring**, at the junction of US-191 and SR-128 north of Moab. Cold, clear, flows 365 days a year, likely sourced from the La Sals about 30 miles southeast. Local legend: couples who drink from it marry; drinking marries you to the land and you always return. Supports "clear and bright" where the muddy Colorado does not, and plants the bride motif three lines early.
- L1 to L2 transition — North on 191, cross the Colorado on the highway bridge, 279 branches left about two miles up and drops onto the river's north bank. Roughly four miles total. The spring's outflow is piped through a culvert under SR-128 into the

Colorado, so the water in L1 physically becomes the water in L2. Posey's walking-distance constraint begins at L2, so a drive here is permitted.

- L2 (waters' silent flight) — The Colorado River along Highway 279, Potash Road.
- L3 (round the bend, past the Hole) — The canyon bend, then the large culvert on the Gold Bar approach to Jeep Arch. Supporting argument: Posey's exclusion language is "man-made buildings," which leaves a culvert available as a passable route feature.
- L4 (cast your pole) — Colorado riverbank along 279. Placeholder, not pinned.

Stanza 3 — the marriage

- L1 (in ursa east his realm) — "Bear east" read as a heading instruction; from Jeep Arch the La Sals lie east. "His realm" = **Mount Waas** (12,306 ft), Grand County high point, named by the Hayden Survey for a local Ute chief; "Waas" also reported to mean "man" in Ute. Older maps label it Mount Nas or Nass.
- L2 (his bride at ancient gates) — **Mount Tukuwnikivatz**, bride to the man mountain, standing at the gates of the range. "Ancient gates" not pinned to a specific feature.
- L3 (her foot of three at twenty degree) — Tuk's three-sided pyramid form. Twenty degrees taken from her foot.
- L4 (return her face) — Tukuwnikivatz is usually translated as roughly "where the sun sets last," a direction-facing name. Reverse her facing: 20 becomes 200.

Stanza 4 — the site

- L1 (double arcs on granite bold) — **Corona Arch and Bowtie Arch**, paired within a few hundred feet on one trail off 279. Corona means crown, Bowtie is a groom's: the wedding pair. The trail's bolted cable and ladder supply a man-made element.
- L2 (secrets of the past still hold) — Petroglyph panels and dinosaur tracks along the Potash corridor. Thematic, not pinned.
- L3 (time's swift race) — The river and the canyon it cut. Thematic.
- L4 (wonder guards this sacred space) — Arch country over the site. Thematic.

Stanza 5 — frame closes

- L1, L2 — Guidance that the solve should be plain, not encrypted.
- L3 — Second em dash, pairing with stanza 1 L3.
- L4 — Closing.

Supporting arguments outside the poem

- Book cover aperture proposed as Jeep Arch rotated 90 degrees. Unverified. Testable by establishing whether Posey had input on cover art; he has stated the interior map was designed by a third party and its errors were not intentional.
- Gold Bar area is BLM land, matching the Bureau of Land Management placard visible in the Netflix packing scene.
- The La Sals sit on the Utah side of the Colorado state line, consistent with Colorado being eliminated while remaining adjacent to it.
- Moab (~38.6°N) is well north of the Santa Fe cutoff.
- The Old Spanish Trail ran from Santa Fe past the La Sals, connecting the region to Fenn country.

Scoreboard

- Pinned to a specific location: 4 lines (2:1, 2:2, 3:1, 4:1)
 - Pinned but contested by a direct Posey statement: 2 lines (2:3, 3:2)
 - Partial, cannot be walked: 2 lines (3:3, 3:4)
 - Thematic only: 4 lines (2:4, 4:2, 4:3, 4:4)
 - Unsolved: all of stanza 1
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12. CONSTRAINTS THIS SOLVE MUST RECONCILE

Recorded here so the tracking system holds the open objections alongside the case.

1. **The Hole.** Posey answered no when asked if the Hole carries a man-made implication. The culvert reading requires that answer to be misleading.
2. **Ladders.** The official rules say you don't need ladders or climbing skills. The Corona Arch trail has a bolted ladder and safety cables. Not disqualifying, since the rule says you don't need them rather than that none exist en route, but it is a second official statement pointing away from that trail.
3. **The bride.** Posey volunteered twice that the bride is not a living person and not someone you can interact with. That clarification only makes sense if the bride reads as person-shaped. Counterweight: he also said the bride is something visible, and that whether "he" is or was living depends on perspective, both of which are compatible with

landforms.

4. **Rotation.** "Return her face" technically implies a physical rotation. A mountain cannot be rotated; a map, an image, or an object can.
 5. **Armchair boundary.** Boots on the ground is not required until stanza four. This solve uses Jeep Arch, a place you must physically stand, to anchor stanza three. If stanzas 1 through 3 are armchair-solvable, the La Sals should be derivable from map and poem alone.
 6. **Granite.** Moab is sandstone; the La Sals are laccolithic intrusive rock. Neither is granite.
 7. **Ursa.** No bear-related naming exists among the La Sal peaks (Waas, Peale, Mellenthin, Tukuhtnikivatz, South Mountain) or the local drainages (Mill Creek, Pack Creek). The nearest bear name, Bears Ears, is roughly 70 miles southwest, wrong direction from Moab.
 8. **Waas etymology.** The "man" translation is hedged in sources; the Ute chief attribution is better supported. Posey has said clues should stand the test of time, which argues against building on a contested translation.
 9. **Direction of travel.** Nothing in stanza 2 L2 specifies bank, downstream, or the choice of 279 over SR-128, which also follows the Colorado from the same junction. The turn onto 279 is currently chosen retroactively by the destination.
 10. **Derivation order.** The solve was built outward from Jeep Arch rather than forward from the poem. Stanza 5 explicitly warns against tangled, twisted finds.
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13. OPEN QUESTIONS WORTH ASKING HIM

Posey answers a monthly Featured Question through Mysterious Writings. Questions phrased specifically but not "on the nose" have gotten real answers.

- Does the Hole refer to something you pass through?
 - Did you have any input on the book's cover art?
 - Is the bride a natural feature or something made?
 - Is "her foot of three" a measurement, a bearing, or a shape?
 - Does "twenty degree" refer to a compass bearing?
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14. KNOWN GAPS IN THIS FILE

- treasure.quest renders its rules and announcements pages dynamically; rules here are transcribed from screenshots, and the full announcements archive has not been read in original form
- The Dillon (June 2025) and Seekers Summit (March 2026) sessions exist primarily as video; answers may exist in them that were never summarized in writing
- The monthly Featured Questions segment is ongoing; entries after August 2026 are not captured here
- MW Discord and forum discussion threads are not represented